

TONY CHOU

Senior Software Engineer • TypeScript, React & AI-Integrated Products

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Software Engineer with 6 years of production experience specializing in TypeScript and React. I've shipped AI-integrated features at enterprise scale at Mailchimp, built real-time collaborative systems with complex multi-layer state management at Product Forge, and independently rebuilt Topstep's onboarding experience while contributing to its real-time trading analytics platform. I thrive in growth-stage companies where engineers have real ownership over what they build and how they build it.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages & Frameworks: TypeScript, JavaScript, React, Next.js, Node.js, Python, React Native

State Management & Real-time: Redux, Redux Toolkit, TanStack Query, Zustand, Liveblocks, WebSockets, SSE

AI & LLMs: Vercel AI SDK, OpenAI API, LLM tool calling, AI Agents, RAG, agentic workflows

Backend & Data: GraphQL, REST APIs, PostgreSQL, SQL, Flask, Docker, Recall.ai API, webhook integrations

Tooling & Observability: Datadog, LaunchDarkly, Sentry, Mixpanel, Git, Vercel, AWS, GCP

Rich Text Editors: Quill, ProseMirror

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Tensure Consulting — Senior Software Engineer • 2020 – Present

Consulting practice delivering the Topstep, Product Forge, and Mailchimp engagements below.

- Deliver full-stack engineering and technical consulting for startup and enterprise clients, working within established production codebases and leading architecture and technical planning.
- Partner with founders, product managers, and stakeholders to translate business requirements into production-ready solutions.
- Mentor a software engineer on the Product Forge team through structured 1:1s, providing career guidance and technical development support.

Topstep — Senior Software Engineer • Sep 2025 – Present | via Tensure (long-term embedded engagement)

Tech Stack: TypeScript, Node.js, React, PostgreSQL, GraphQL, AWS, Datadog, LaunchDarkly

- Contributed to the data model design and helped build the GraphQL API layer and React UI for the Trader Public Profile platform, delivering real-time trade metrics to users.
- Ported trade metric computation from Topstep's existing TypeORM-based Node.js implementation into the company's new GraphQL API architecture to support the Trader Public Profile feature, working closely with stakeholders to validate calculation accuracy for high-volume trader accounts.
- Independently rebuilt user onboarding with route-based workflows, A/B testing via LaunchDarkly feature flags, and Datadog instrumentation to track drop-off at each step — uncovered drop-off at an unexpected step, directly informing the next iteration.

Product Forge — Senior Full-Stack Engineer • Jan 2024 – 2025 | via Tensure (long-term embedded engagement)

Tech Stack: Next.js, React, TypeScript, Flask, PostgreSQL, Recall.ai API

- Architected a three-layer state management system for real-time collaborative editing — Liveblocks for shared document state across concurrent users, TanStack Query for server-persisted state with cache invalidation, and a Context/reducer pattern for local UI state — eliminating a class of stale-state and re-render bugs caused by treating all three as one undifferentiated store.
- Contributed to an agentic AI assistant (Vercel AI SDK) that autonomously fetched meeting transcripts, extracted product insights, and updated user stories from a single instruction — building the transcript-chunking logic to fit large meetings within the model's context window, improving tool-selection prompting and artifact-type detection, and adding a coordination layer to prevent the assistant's search tools from executing simultaneously.
- Designed and built core backend subsystems for the Flask API — Clerk auth/organization webhooks, request middleware, structured Cloud Run logging, data export, the feedback system, and Mixpanel analytics integration — while authoring 21 database schema migrations.
- Built and maintained the API layer bridging a companion Chrome extension to the core backend — bearer-token authentication, Liveblocks real-time sync passthrough, and full artifact/meeting CRUD proxying — sustained across a year of iteration including a first-time-user onboarding flow.
- Designed and implemented the original debounced autosave system for the artifact editor, iterating on save timing and reliability across multiple releases to balance responsiveness against write load.

Mailchimp / Intuit — Software Engineer II • Jan 2020 – 2023 | via Tensure (long-term embedded engagement)

Tech Stack: React, TypeScript, Redux, ProseMirror

- Before the AI feature, integrated a content-generation engine Mailchimp had acquired into the ProseMirror email editor — an earlier, pre-AI automated content tool that the LLM-based feature later replaced.
- Co-led frontend engineering for Mailchimp's first-generation AI content generation feature, shipped to millions of users — one of the earliest AI integrations in the product.
- Co-led a team of 3–4 engineers to architect and deliver AI content generation on top of the existing ProseMirror-based email editor, supporting two concurrent editor versions simultaneously.

- Extended AI-generated content into Mailchimp's Automation Flows, wiring generated copy into trigger-based automated email sequences beyond the single-email editor.
- Partnered with the data analytics team to instrument tracking for new AI-generated content features, establishing feedback loops to measure adoption and inform iteration.
- Co-led a migration from SQL to Google Cloud Spanner, learning the then-new technology quickly to help drive the initiative — reducing annual infrastructure costs by \$500K through staged migrations and comprehensive regression testing.

Fugue AI — Co-Founder & Engineering Lead • 2022 – 2024

Part-time venture, run alongside consulting work.

- Co-founded an AI creative platform integrating DALL·E and Stable Diffusion image generation models, built full-stack on AWS, reaching 500+ users; owned all engineering decisions end-to-end, from infrastructure to product prioritization.

EDUCATION

Master of Occupational Therapy — The Ohio State University